

## **20's LECTURE PROJECT**

### **The Stock Market Crash of 1920**

#### **Problems Of Buying Stock Margins**

When buying on margin, an investor purchases an asset by borrowing the difference from a bank or broker. People were putting down as little as 10 percent and ended up borrowing the rest from brokers and making huge bets with little of their money at risk. Interest is charged on borrowed funds, which accrues daily and significantly erodes the profits you make over time. This is especially likely to happen when positions are held for a prolonged period.

If the stock price falls, your losses will be greater than if you had only invested with your own cash. It is possible to lose more money than you had originally invested. You're still responsible for repaying the full amount plus interest.

#### **Black Tuesday & Black Thursday**

Black Thursday was on Oct/24/1929, it was the first day of the historic Wall Street stock crash. A record number of shares were traded as panic selling began. 12.9 million shares were traded, causing the Dow Jones Industrial Average to fall drastically.

Black Tuesday happened on October/29/1929. The stock market was experiencing a catastrophic collapse as panic selling ensued. Billions of dollars in stock value were lost as the Dow Jones Industrial Average plummeted. A record of 16.4 million shares was traded that day. Black Tuesday & Thursday were the most devastating crashes in the country's history. It triggered a rapid erosion of confidence in the U.S banking system and marked the beginning of the Great Depression.

#### **The Stock Market Crash**

The U.S economy became very small, and the prices fell a TON. Around 7,000 banks failed by 1933. There was a huge unemployment risk, and it peaked around 25% in the U.S by 1933, with millions jobless. The wages dropped around 60%.

The Dust Bowl was another thing that happened in 1930, and it caused various things. There was a drought, poor farming, and high winds. There was a dust storm called the "black blizzard," and it destroyed a bunch of crops. People had to end up abandoning their homes.

Social impact around this time. Families faced problems like hunger, foreclosures, and instability. Their lifestyles and resourcefulness changed, and they basically had to make do with what they had.

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## Women in the 1920's

### **Women's Suffrage- The 19th Amendment**

The 19th Amendment was ratified in the Constitution on June,4,1919 as an official law. The 19th Amendment caused a permanent change to all the people who are allowed to vote forever, with the inclusion of millions of women.

Despite this, women of a minority were still not allowed to vote. This amendment sparked an increase in feminist activism and legal battles among debates. As well as the development of the flapper.

Women wanted to fight for women to be recognized as full citizens with the same rights as men, so in 1920, 36% of women were eligible to vote out of 68% of men.

### **Flappers**

Flappers were a style that emerged from feminism, which was way ahead of their time. They are defined by their more carefree lifestyle, and an opposition to how women were "supposed to behave. During the 1920s, flappers' behaviors were synonymous with the style that was seen as "scandalous and immoral.

This new style wave served as a milestone for women to push societal norms. Not only in terms of attitude, but in politics and economics as well, by taking pride in consumerism. They pushed ideas at the time with women's suffrage and women's rights.

### **Famous Flappers**

Louise Brooks was an American film actress during the 1920s and 1930s. She was known as a silent film icon. She was famous for her involvement with flapper culture. Her bobbed hair and rebellious style improved her popularity during the prime of her career.

Louise Brooks was one of the greatest female icons in the history of cinema, making over thirty films. She was also a dancer and later on became a writer.

Her roles in silent & flapper films influenced thousands of women to get her famous bobbed haircut.

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# Radio

## **The Invention of Radio**

Guglielmo Marconi invented the first ever wireless radio in the 1890s. Marconi and many others around the world contributed to making the first wireless radio. Although Guglielmo got credit, there were others who came up with the invention, but unfortunately wasn't successful because of commercial views. Marconi, on the other hand, gained popularity with his commercials and soon got labeled. The inventor of the best wireless radios.

Though there is a serious debate if Heinrich Hertz and Nikola Tesla deserved full or partial credit. Tesla had discovered the functional radio components, but they weren't investigated until after the fact. Later on, Marconi's patent was reversed. Hertz proved the physics part of radio waves, and Tesla built the components.

## **The invention of Radio**

Many people loved radios because of how they could deliver news, so people didn't have to get newspapers every day. Many early broadcast stations had music that played through the radio for the people to hear. Along with sports and drama. Everybody was enjoying having a radio. It was like how everybody enjoys having the newest iPhone nowadays. People were connected from around the world with radios being invented. The invention of the radio was a great idea and was really effective and worth buying. Radios have changed so much over time, with the new technology being used to make them. Radios also made people feel less isolated. People around the world started purchasing radios after they started getting popular throughout the 1920s. It was one of the biggest inventions at the time.

## **Famous Radio Programs**

During the 1920s, there were many popular/famous radio programs. One in particular was a program that consisted of "The Happiness Boys. The Happiness Boys were a comedy music duo. The boys themselves were Billy Jones, who lived from 1889 to 1940, and Ernie Hare 1883 to 1939. They both specialized in comic songs. Their biggest hits were "Ain't Misbehaving" and "Downhearted Blues". Their radio programs ran throughout the 1920s and 1930s. That was until Ernie got sick. When he was ill, his 15-year-old daughter, Marilyn Hare, filled in for him, but when he died, she was a part of the program full-time with Jones. Not long after continuing within the year, she got a huge movie offer and left for Hollywood, and Billy died later that following year.

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## **Negative Impact Of Prohibition**

## **Bootlegging & Speakeasies**

Bootlegging and speakeasies were the illegal trafficking and sale of alcohol, while the 18th Amendment was active for 13 years bootleggers supplied the liquor by any means. Speakeasies provided the demand and location, forming an intertwined underworld business right under the government's nose. Speakeasies, there were secret, illegal bars or nightclubs that served alcohol. In order to get into a speakeasy they required passwords or secret knocks to enter, often disguised as legitimate businesses, for example: soda shops, cafes, and barber shops, etc. Bootleggers either produced alcohol illegally (Known as Moonshine) or smuggled it from other countries. They often used cars with hidden compartments or fast boats to evade law enforcement. Bootlegging fueled the rise of powerful gangs.

## **Organized Crime (Al Capone)**

Al Capone was born in New York City in 1899 to Italian immigrants. As a teenager, he was consumed by a life of crime and was a bouncer in organized crime premises, such as his brothers. In his early twenties, he moved to Chicago to be a bodyguard for Johnny Torrio, head of a criminal syndicate that illegally supplied alcohol. Al Capone was sometimes known by the nickname "Scarface". Capone was an American gangster and businessman who attained notoriety during the prohibition era, as the cofounder and boss of the Chicago outfit from 1925 to 1931. His seven-year reign as a crime boss ended when he was imprisoned at the age of 33. A conflict with the North Side gang was instrumental in Capone's rise and fall. Torrio retired after a North Side gunman almost killed him, handing control to Capone. Although Capone expanded the bootlegging business through increasingly violent means, his mutually profitable relationships with Mayor William Hale Thompson.

## **The Repeal Of The Prohibition (21st Amendment)**

The 18th Amendment, which was called the Prohibition Amendment, ended the buying and selling of alcohol nationwide for 13 years, and was repealed by the 21st Amendment on December 5th, 1933. The 21st Amendment also gave the states the power to make their own alcohol laws. However, making really strong alcohol was not allowed in the United States to regulate the alcohol consumption in the country so there wouldn't be people drunk, or passed out in the streets, which was the whole point of why the 18th amendment was passed. Another reason why the 21st Amendment was ratified was to stop crime which became rampant because of the 18th amendment being passed and people wanting alcohol.

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## **The Scopes Monkey Trial**

### **Background Facts**

The Scopes “Monkey” Trial happened in 1925 in Dayton, Tennessee. It started because a teacher named John Scopes was accused of breaking a state law by teaching evolution in his science class. But the case quickly drew attention because it questioned what students are allowed to learn in school. The Trial soon became a huge national event. Because two famous men were involved, Clarence Darrow, who backed Scopes, and William Jennings Bryan, who argued for the state. So many people came to see what they were doing, so they had to move part of the trial outside. It basically turned into a big crowd between science and religion. Even though Scopes was found guilty and fined \$100, the case made a big impact. It got so many people all over the U.S. talking about what schools should teach and whether evolution should be allowed.

### **Clarence Darrow VS. William Jennings Bryan**

The Scopes Trial in 1925 was a big argument about whether teachers should be allowed to teach evolution in school. Clarence Darrow, the defense lawyer, supported teaching science and wanted students to learn real facts. During the trial, he questioned William Jennings Bryan and showed that Bryan’s strict Bible-based beliefs didn't match what science says.

Bryan, a famous politician who was very religious, thought evolution shouldn’t be taught because it went against the Bible. But when Darrow asked him science questions, Bryan struggled to answer and didn’t seem very confident.

Even though John Scopes was found guilty, most people felt Darrow made the better arguments. In a surprising turn of events, Bryan died the day after the trial.

### **Intro to the Verdict and Impacted**

The verdict was that John Scopes, a 24-year-old high school teacher, was found guilty of teaching about evolution to his biology class. John Scopes was fined about 100\$ for the offence. John was found guilty because he deliberately broke Tennessee’s Butler Act.

The Butler Act was put in place to protect religion and traditional values from the more modern scientific ideas, and he broke that law, which led him to be fined. The case started July 10th and came to a close on July 21st, 1925, although a 100\$ fine doesn't seem like much, in today's money it would be about 1,400\$ fine. Also, a fun fact, this was the first trial to be broadcast live on the radio. This trial was a very big deal, so big

it had some major impacts in the world, even outside of Tennessee, and it also started a national debate on science vs religion.

The national debate sparked the modern culture war over whether evolution should be taught in school. It divided religion and science, a debate that still goes on today, even though Scopes didn't win. It made people start talking about what should be taught in school.

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## Silent Movies

### **Charlie Chaplin**

Charlie Chaplin was born in London on April 16, 1889. He was named after his father, Charles Chaplin, Sr. Charlie's childhood was very rough. His father was absent, and his mother struggled financially. Charlie was sent to work at a workhouse at the age of nine, and at age 14, his mother was sent to a mental asylum. When he was nineteen, he was scouted for a film company, which took him to the United States. Soon after his debut film, *Making a Living*, he introduced his famous persona, the Tramp. He did not always play as a tramp; in many films, he is employed as a waiter, store clerk, and fireman. He was an English comic actor and filmmaker. He became an icon when he starred in various silent films. By 1918, he was one of the best-paid celebrities in the world. He is considered one of the greatest filmmakers in history, even though he is from London. He passed away from a stroke on Christmas in 1977.

### **The Era of Silent Films**

The beginning of silent films was in the 1890s, when it was greatly evolved by Thomas Edison and the Lumiere brothers, who worked on machines that projected images. Silent movies live up to their name, just movies that didn't have sound. That's also what made them special, because they can be enjoyed and understood by people around the world, no matter the language they speak. Because of the lack of dialogue, the films relied on over-the-top expressions and gestures. Sometimes paired with text cards for important conversations, but the visual storytelling is strong enough to communicate the plot. So almost everything relied on the actor's skill, because they had to channel everything through their body language.

### **The Dark Side of Silent Films**

Even though the Silent Film era was nicknamed the golden era, it was far from it. It was filled with racism, homophobia, and sexism. The studio dictated a lot of actors' lives; they even went as far as not letting them go to some events so the actor could keep a specific image. Studios never really cared for their actors; they saw them as replaceable assets to exploit. The safety standards in place were also ridiculously low,

meaning the actors were always in danger while trying to do a stunt. There were also no safety precautions, like when actress Grace Mchugh, along with a cameraman, drowned while trying to shoot Across the Border.

If an actor got an injury during a stunt, studios often encourage them to take addictive drugs. Due to studios enforcing this on their actors, it led to the death of Wallace Reid, caused by his morphine addiction. There was also a huge scandal during the prohibition era when Hollywood parties were filled with drugs, even though they were selling and making alcohol that was outlawed in 1919.

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## **The Harlem Renaissance**

### **Background Facts**

The Harlem neighborhood, which was in New York, was considered an upper-class with a white community. Then the African American family was able to move in with a large number of family members. That's what started the cultural center of African Americans.

The Harlem Renaissance was a cultural movement that started in the 1910s and continued through the 1930s. It was centered in Harlem, New York. They started this movement to celebrate African American heritage through their music, arts, and literature on stage. African Americans were moved from the South to the North, and during that period, it was called "The Golden Age" of African American culture.

The Harlem Renaissance movement's downfall was mostly due to the Great Depression. Which had started like the stock market crashing in 1929. This led to venues like the Cotton Club, to close.

### **Jazz In the 1920s**

Jazz started big in New Orleans, then started to populate to America. Jazz in the 1920s was called the "Jazz Age". A lot of the stuff that really got Jazz Popular was the radio and some stars like Louis Armstrong and Bessie Smith. They started coming up with new dances during Jazz, and people were having the time of their lives.

The culture was also really strong in jazz despite the racial tensions. The Racial tensions segregated some venues like the Cotton Club in New York. African American communities pretty much started it in New Orleans then it started to spread into something big through Chicago and New York.

### **Musical Theatre in the 1920s**

During the Harlem Renaissance, drama and theatre became an important way for African Americans to share their stories and culture. In Harlem, New York, theatres like the Lafayette Theatre were places where black actors and playwrights could perform and tell stories about their lives. These plays and performances during the Harlem Renaissance were about real-life topics. They talked about important issues like standing up for equal rights, being proud of who you are, and working through



challenges. These shows not only entertained the audience but also taught lessons and brought people together.

Many black actors and theatre groups worked hard to make their voices heard. They wanted to show the world how talented Black artists were and prove that their stories mattered.

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## **Sports in the 1920s**

### **Sports Facts in the 1920s**

The 1920s were known as the Roaring 20s and were the time of many great athletes. The most popular sports at the time were baseball, football, boxing, basketball, and golf. The first radio broadcast of a football game was in 1921, which significantly increased the popularity of sports, and in 1929, the New York Yankees became the first sports team to put numbers on their uniforms. The 1920s were also the time of the uprising in women's sports all around the world.

The first time the Olympic flag was flown was in 1920 at the Summer Olympics in Antwerp, Belgium. In 1924, the Paris Olympics showcased international talent and further popularized sports like athletics, tennis, and swimming. In 1920, the NFL was founded, and at the same time was called the APFA.

### **Jack Dempsey**

Before Mike Tyson, Muhamed Ali, there was Jack Dempsey. His real name is William Harrison Dempsey. He got his name, Jack Dempsey from a boxing offer his brother gave him to fight in his place. William accepted and went to the ring as Jack Dempsey, winning the match and claiming his brother's name. Jack Dempsey was also one of Mike Tyson's idols growing up because of his ferocious fighting style and for his favorite move, the "Dempsey Roll".

Born on June 24, 1895, Jack Dempsey was a kid growing up in poverty in Manassas, Colorado. When he was in his teenage years, Jack would start fighting for bets to make money. He was influenced by his older brother during his childhood to box. In his early years, he went by the name "Kid Blackie". Then, in his teenage years, he would fight so aggressively that his hometown would call him "The Manassa Mauler".

He left home at 16 to fight in bars and gyms. After he took over the name Jack Dempsey, he went on a 32-game undefeated win streak and became a fan favorite in fights. In Jack Dempsey's career, he had an impressive record of 62 wins, 6 losses, and 9 draws. He was inducted into the International Boxing Hall of Fame in 1990.



## **Babe Ruth**

George Herman Ruth Jr., or Babe Ruth, born in Baltimore, Maryland, on February 6, 1895, was introduced to baseball when he was sent to an industrial school for boys. A mentor in the industry recognized his raw talent and taught him pitching, hitting, and fielding. Which led to him becoming a young prodigy at baseball. At 17, he signed to join the Baltimore Orioles. But he would quickly switch over to the Boston Red Sox. Becoming one of the best baseball players of all time and one of the most iconic athletes in history.

Babe Ruth gained his fame as a dominant left-handed pitcher for the Boston Red Sox. But he also became a legendary power-hitting outfielder for the New York Yankees. He finished his career with 714 home runs and a .342 batting average. He also holds the world record for the highest slugging percentage at .690, also winning 7 World Series. Babe Ruth was inducted into the Hall of Fame in 1939.